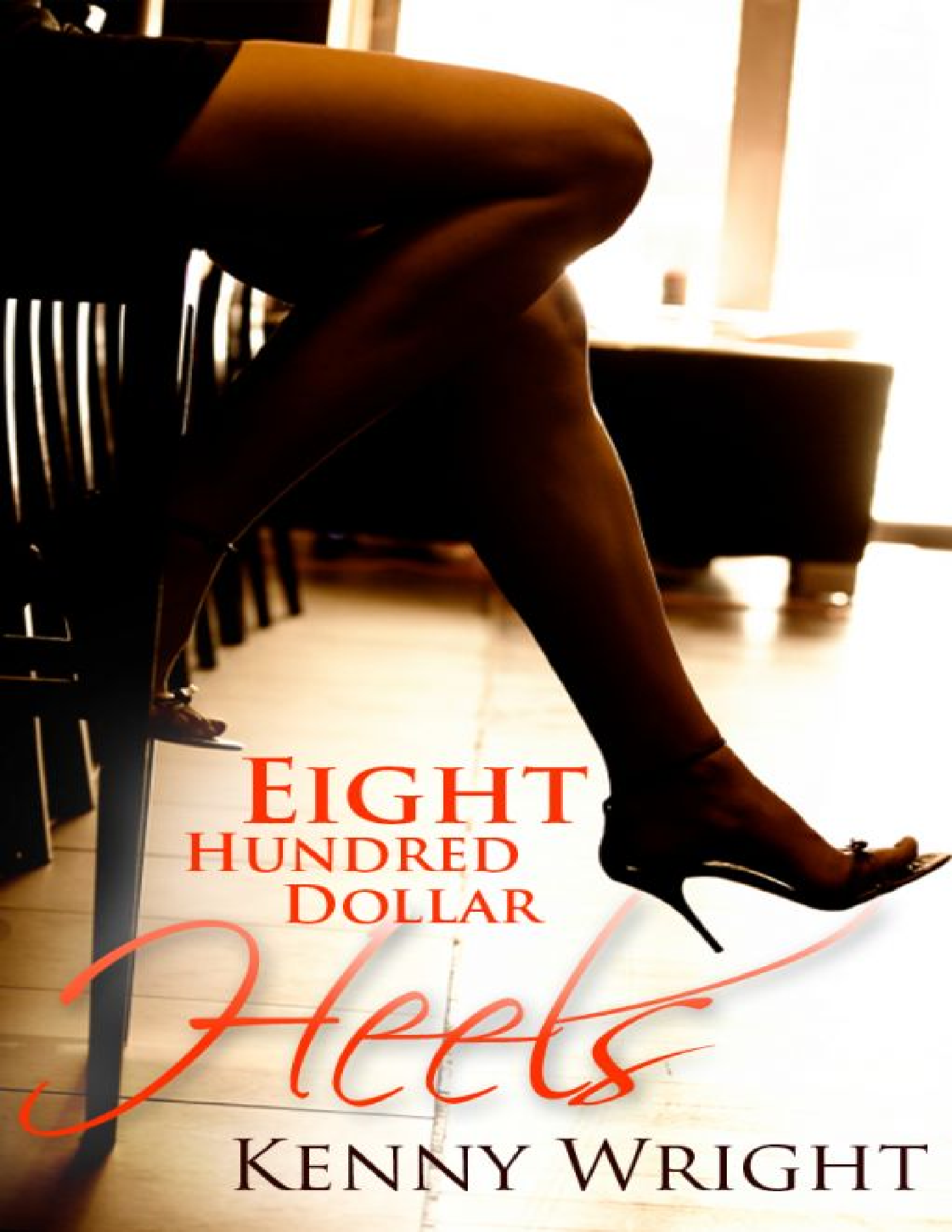


A photograph of a woman's legs from the knees down, wearing black high-heeled shoes. She is sitting on a dark wooden chair with vertical slats. The background is a bright, out-of-focus interior space with a light-colored floor and a dark piece of furniture. The text is overlaid on the lower half of the image.

EIGHT
HUNDRED
DOLLAR

Heels

KENNY WRIGHT

Eight Hundred Dollar Shoes

Kenny Wright
Smashwords Edition
Copyright June 2012

Edited by Summer Wright and Lucy V. Morgan

Cover design by Kenny Wright

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Deanna Adams wasn't narcissistic, but she couldn't stop staring at herself in the mirror behind the bar. She barely recognized the reflection: a beautiful brunette with a tanned face, bright with makeup and more than a little wonder, stirring the remains of her martini.

A little embarrassed at her vanity, she surveyed the rest of the bar and saw eyes watching her, wanting her. A rush welled up in her like bubbles through champagne, chasing out the last of the day's weariness. Deanna

had always been stared at, but she noticed the attention more than ever since coming to LA for this trial.

Most stares were furtive, glancing away like rats from a spotlight, only to turn back when they thought it was safe. Others were bold enough to meet her eyes without apology. Some even shot her a wink and a smile. Those were the ones that caused her heart to skip. The ones that compelled her to rub the platinum band of her wedding ring for strength.

A man entered the bar and looked around. Their eyes met in the mirror. His were dark to match her own, and the wrinkles that formed at their corners when he smiled caused her to tremble. He nodded, and she forced herself to look away.

How many years had it been since she'd had someone look at her like that? So wanted. So ready to be taken.

She went for her drink again, only to find it empty. Plucking the spear of olives from the glass, she watched her reflection crush the liquor-saturated olives between her white teeth.

And how many years had it been since she'd looked at herself and been stunned?

LA is really rubbing off on you, honey. She laughed to herself, putting it out of her head (but not before she stole one last look at Mr. Dark Eyes). He was saying something to the hostess: No thanks, I'll sit at the bar, his lips seemed to say as he looked in her direction again. Her heart beat just a little faster.

"Can I get you another?" a man beside her asked, drawing her attention away from the dangerous flirtation.

Surprised, she looked at her latest suitor. She'd noticed him when he sat next to her, but he hadn't said a word and was one of the few guys who hadn't been staring. Apparently, he'd been biding his time, waiting for this moment to pounce. She wasn't used to feeling hunted but found that she liked it. The warmth forming between her thighs warned that she might like it too much.

"I probably shouldn't, but sure." One martini into the night and she felt her judgment beginning to slip. Deanna had been with her husband for over a decade and had never strayed. Never been tempted.

But that didn't mean she couldn't appreciate all this newfound attention, and this guy had some seriously sexy hazel eyes. Neat brown

hair, dimpled chin, looked good in a suit—he was like a checklist of things she looked for in a man.

Once the martini was ordered, he turned to her, leaning on the bar, and said, “You look familiar.”

Deanna rolled her eyes. “Really? That the best you’ve got?” Her question flustered him. She liked that.

“I’m serious.” He waved to the bartender. “Megan, doesn’t this beautiful young woman look familiar?”

Deanna kept her amusement at being called “young” to herself; if anything, she had a few years on this guy, who couldn’t have been beyond his late twenties.

“You know, I’d been thinking that since she sat down.” The bartender was pretty in a cool-casual way. Ponytail. Black tank top. Tight, black jeans.

“How much is he paying you?” Deanna asked.

Megan laughed. “Oh, I should be getting paid?” She turned to the guy. “Craig, you’re holding out on me.”

That coaxed a laugh from Deanna.

“I knew I shouldn’t have said anything to you,” he said. “Pretty women always get me in trouble.”

Megan jabbed a finger in his direction. “Now that I can vouch for.”

“So you’re a regular at a hotel bar?” Deanna asked.

“Hey, don’t judge. You’re the one all dressed up and alone on a Friday night.”

“Hey, I’m coming from work.” Deanna swiveled on her stool, hands clasping her knees, crossed legs playing defense between her and Craig. “I hope the girls going out in LA try a little harder.” Both the black pencil skirt with its ruffled hem and her matching black blouse were courtesy of the corporate card. The Louboutins were a splurge of her own, black patent leather and tall enough to match her newfound confidence.

“Where do you work, and do they have any openings?”

“Taylor Schultz & Royce LLP. They might have something in the mail room.” Deanna laughed at her haughtiness. She felt like she was playing a character—a really fun character.

He snapped his fingers and pointed. That lovely smile of his extended all the way to his eyes. “I’ve got it. You’re representing Vince Roddick, right? With Bruce Taylor and his team?”

“Court TV fan, huh?”

Megan the bartender answered for him. “That’s it! That’s a pretty big case. Definitely not just Court TV.” She glanced at the television and smiled. “I rest my case.”

As fate would have it, the television was running through news highlights of the day. Bruce Taylor stood on the courthouse steps, fielding questions with non-answers. Roddick stood to his right, his hefty body squeezed into a sharp-looking suit. Chatting with him was Deanna as they did their best to ignore any errant questions that got by Bruce. Watching herself up there was completely out-of-body.

The newscaster rattled off all the latest buzzwords from the case. Vince Roddick, youngest baseball player to reach 500 home runs at age 30, was being tried for perjury, allegedly lying about his use of performance enhancing drugs. Deanna had heard it all before. The sports media had turned this into the premiere trial of the steroid era.

“Is it weird, seeing yourself up there on TV?” Craig asked.

She looked back at Craig, realizing he was much closer than he’d been before. He was still on his own stool, but had scooted it close enough that his arm resting on the bar was practically touching her. Heat billowed through her and she hated herself for feeling it. Not that she pushed him away.

She caught a glimpse of them in the mirror and knew what this looked like. Megan was gone, leaving the two of them alone. What would her husband think of this? His shy wife flirting with this good-looking man.

Craig was handsome in a southern California kind of way. Broad shoulders. Bronzed complexion. He could have any woman in here, and yet there he was, studying her like a wolf eyeing its prey.

Two weeks ago, this wouldn’t have happened. She wouldn’t come into a bar alone, thousands of miles from home. She wouldn’t have had that egotistic epiphany. She didn’t think she’d even have a guy like Craig hitting on her.

Shaking her head, Deanna turned back to him. God, his face was right there. “Yeah, it’s kind of weird. I keep wondering what the hell I’m doing here, and if everyone thinks I’m an impostor.” She had to reach around his arm to retrieve her martini, and on a whim, she brushed up against him.

Without moving away to clear space, she drew the glass between them, feeling his eyes on her lips as she drank.

"I don't think you're an impostor." When she set the drink down, he continued. "Listen, I'd love to buy you dinner.."

"Would you?" Deanna wondered if that came out as steady as she'd intended; she was jittery enough that it was hard to self-evaluate. "Too bad I've already eaten."

Craig licked his lips and shifted. "Another drink then. In the bar in my suite?"

She felt the hand on her knee. Her face burned. "I'm sorry if I left the wrong impression." She held up her left hand, her diamond band flashing in the dim light. His hand slid up her thigh and Deanna pushed a breath through her pursed lips.

His grin filled with presumption. "I don't think so. I'm pretty sure my impression is very correct."

"No, seriously. You did." She stopped his hand before it could reach the lacy texture of her stocking top. Her voice was firm, yet her fingers lingered on his hand.

Craig opened his mouth to say something—probably along the lines of how her mouth said one thing while her body was saying another—and opened her mouth to interject. Someone else beat her.

"Is this guy bothering you?" The voice was deep and firm.

Deanna looked up, right into the face of her dark-eyed admirer. He shared a soft smile with her.

Craig's stool scraped along the floor as he stood, turning toward Deanna's savior. "Can I help you, friend?" The word had never sounded so unfriendly.

"You can get your hands off my wife."

Deanna watched as Craig's brow tightened in an ugly knot. He looked from Deanna to Dark Eyes and back again. "What the fuck kind of game is this?"

It was amazing how fast a person could go from confident swagger to unattractive brute. Deanna wondered if these two men were about to fight over her. Wouldn't that be exciting...?

"Got to keep things interesting," the new man said, placing a hand on the small of her back. "Isn't that right, honey?" With no further warning,

he leaned down and kissed her. And sweet Jesus, it was some kiss—as powerful as those eyes promised, full of need and hunger and passion. When it was over and she was left gasping for breath, Craig was gone.

“Thanks for that,” she said.

“No problem. You looked like you needed some help.” Craig’s smile was nice in a blocky, superhero kind of way, but this guy’s... fuck, it was just sexy. “I’m Noah.”

Craig’s flirtation coupled with that kiss—not to mention one-and-a-half martinis—had her solidly in giddy schoolgirl territory. Even all the makeovers and tailored suits didn’t make her feel this exuberant.

“I’m Deanna. And I’m married.”

“I see that.” Noah took Craig’s vacated seat and met the bartender’s eyes long enough to summon her. Deanna shivered at his self-assuredness.

“And that doesn’t bother you?”

“Does it bother you?”

His question gave her pause. He placed his hand on her knee. “No,” she said, quiet enough that she wasn’t sure she’d said it aloud.

“Then it doesn’t bother me, either.”

Megan had returned. If she had a problem with the change in clientele, she didn’t show it. “I’ll have a Maker’s Mark, on the rocks. And Deanna here will have a small glass of chilled Chardonnay.”

“I will, will I?”

Noah nodded. “And you won’t be finishing that,” he said, pushing the remnants of the martini glass away. “The last thing I want is for you to be drunk.”

“Oh yeah?”

“Yeah.”

Deanna stumbled as she searched for what to say. “Who are you?” Her question degenerated into a laugh.

“A fan, Deanna Adams.”

“Another Court TV enthusiast.”

Megan came by with their drinks, setting cocktail napkins down and drinks atop without a word.

“Surely you watch the news. You’re all over the place. ESPN has even called you out specifically.”

“Really?” She had no idea.

“Then I won’t go on to tell you about the websites. Now those are real fans...”

Was he serious? She wasn’t completely naive and she knew the Internet was a haven for every kind of deviant thought possible. She just never figured she’d be one of them. The idea worked more fizzy excitement through her.

“Tell me, Deanna dear, why are you sitting here by yourself on a Friday night?”

The honest answer? Or the suggestive one? The former wasn’t nearly as fun as the latter. “Maybe I was waiting for you...”

Up close, his smile was even better. “Good answer.” The rush that came with his praise was stronger than when she made a good point in the courtroom. “So had that guy asked you up to his room yet?”

“He was just getting around to it.” Noah’s hand made the same journey up the outside of her thigh that Craig’s had, but she didn’t stop it this time. When he reached the edge of her stocking, his smile broadened.

“Guys are too impatient these days.” He took a sip of his bourbon. “A little more time and maybe he would have been successful.”

“You think?” She pressed her lips together. “So I look like that kind of woman?” She swiveled back around to face the bar, pulling her leg out of his flirty clutch.

They found one another in the mirror. “That’s just it. I don’t think you’re that kind of woman at all.” He shook his head. “You are so beautiful.”

She watched herself gasp. It was such an obvious line except... that it wasn’t. It wasn’t an empty compliment, designed to get her into bed. She couldn’t keep looking at all that sincerity and ended up looking down at her glass of wine, which was nearly empty.

“You going to ask me if I want another back up in yours?” She glanced up at him through her lashes. His reflection was watching her.

“I don’t want you to have another. I told you, I don’t want to get you drunk.”

“But isn’t that the goal of men like you and women like me?”

“It’s a crutch, sure. But tell me, Deanna Adams, do you really think I need it?”

Deanna had spent the last two weeks hyper-vigilant of how she conducted herself in public. More times than not, there was a camera on

her—they were in the courtroom. They were on the steps of the courthouse. They were at the press conferences, and on rare occasions, they were outside the hotel where the law team had set up headquarters. It had been explained that while they were in LA representing Roddick, it was of the utmost importance to remain professional.

Yet as she sat there, knee-to-knee, leaning on the bar and staring into Noah's eyes, she was no longer thinking about that little talk. Hell, she wasn't thinking like a successful woman with ten years of law experience behind her. If professionalism was an outfit like the ones her stylist had hanging on a rack, then Noah had already stripped her of that and left it limp and forgotten on the bar floor.

They didn't leave immediately. They actually stayed and chatted. They talked about Vince Roddick and what it was like to work with someone with such a bloated ego. About how strange it was to be on such a high profile case ("The network pays for weekly visits to the spa for everyone on staff."). If she didn't know better, she would have suspected that Noah was a reporter (or worse, someone from the DA's office).

But she knew better. He actually cared about what she was saying. He didn't just watch her lips and imagine them wrapped around his cock—although she was pretty sure there was some of that, too. She was love-struck for the first time in many years.

Deanna couldn't blame it on alcohol. They'd remained long enough for her to sober up. All she had was her libido, although that alone was doing a pretty good job clouding her mind. When he asked her if she wanted to leave, she agreed, and as they walked across the lobby, she didn't ask who's room they were headed to. She just let herself be led.

"You look taller on TV. Now I see why. Nice shoes." They were waiting for the elevator to arrive, watching themselves in the glossy gold doors. Even at four inches with platforms, the pumps just barely brought her to Noah's shoulder.

"Best eight hundred dollars I've ever spent." Finally, some shock registered on his pretty face. She turned into him and kissed the side of his neck. "Actually, the five hundred I paid for my Italian lingerie was pretty good, too."

Nuzzling her head along his shoulder, she caught their reflection one last time before the doors slid open. He was regarding her with an

incredulous half-smile that seemed to say, Lawyers...

An elderly woman joined them in the elevator, greeting them with a hello that felt laced with judgment. Deanna was in a suit. Noah was in half of one. Nothing appeared illicit, yet everything felt so wrong. It was fantastic.

In some ways, everything about this moment was inevitable, but that didn't stop it feeling fresh. Like walking through her house, but in a dream. The hotel corridor with its endless stretch of doors. The sound of the key-card in its brass cradle. Even the smell of cleaning solution and carpeting that greeted them as they tumbled in. Every detail was *deja vu new*.

Deanna curled her hands around the corded muscles of Noah's arms as he drove kisses into her. She had rarely felt such imbalance. She'd been a woman working for equality since before she'd ever met her husband. They'd always split checks. They'd planned their wedding together, divvying up the tasks equally.

Tonight was different. She didn't know that's what she was looking for when she situated herself at the bar, but as she watched the eyes watch her, she felt that deeply buried desire begin to stretch from its long slumber.

Noah took her. He overpowered her. And she wanted that. Wanted it bad enough that her body ached for it. She wanted to scream. Wanted to rip his shirt open and walk her fingers across his lightly haired chest. But she didn't. She demurred to him, looking up through her lashes as he held her by the shoulders.

"I'm going to enjoy fucking you." His words were a shot of pure adrenaline.

She shook with it, unable to stop as his fingers grabbed her tailored black blouse and tore it open. Deanna gasped. "Who are you?" she asked as he drank in the mesh and lace of her expensive bra.

"Who are you?" He touched the lingerie, feeling its supple construction.

Their lips crashed into one another again. He peeled her torn blouse off her slender arms and she finally got her hands inside his shirt. She slipped the backs of her knuckles along the hard peaks of his chest and rapped them across nipples that had tightened into little knots.

They struggled with the rest of their clothes as they sparred across the hotel suite. Noah's shirt was flung halfway into the bathroom. His trousers

and Deanna's skirt marked the ragged trail to the suite's sitting area.

"Boxer-briefs." Deanna approved as Noah pushed her down into the sofa and stretched his back. "You are a very sexy man." The briefs were black and tight, molded around his erection and the heavy bulge beneath. Deanna caught herself licking her lips, paused, then decided to finish the action with a laugh.

He wasn't as muscular as she imagined Craig would have been, but guys like Craig weren't really her type anyway. She liked a man who embodied the word "svelte" and Noah was that with a capital S. His broad shoulders were an added bonus.

"I've always wondered what five hundred dollar lingerie looked like." His gaze felt great as it moved all over her.

Feeling bold, Deanna led his eyes with her fingers, swirling them down her stomach to the gauzy edge of her thong. "The quality is more in the way it feels than how it looks." She pushed her fingers into the gusset, where everything was smooth and sweltering. The expensive panties pulled away from her skin just enough to tease, to suggest that maybe, just maybe, she was shaved. Noah was looking, some of that confidence knocked out of his face. She retreated, letting it snap back into place, and lounged back on the sofa. "Yeah, definitely worth the money."

A warmth spread through her as she splayed herself before this sexy, sexy man—a wet heat like a humid summer day. It rolled through her body, licking her thighs, her pussy, the tips of her nipples. She didn't do this. She didn't act like a whore, although based on the way Noah consumed the lewd display, she thought that maybe she'd been too quick to judge.

He poured over her like a waterfall—liquid beauty with so much power. Their mouths met in the fall, her hands curling at the base of his neck without the strength to clutch. A knee nestled between her thighs and she mewed at the blissful pressure.

Noah pulled back, let her moan, and smiled. I did that, his smug expression said. He nudged his knee harder. Higher. Her clit flattened against his muscled thigh and her eyes fluttered.

They kissed, her hands tightening in the taper of his hair as he fed his tongue between her lips. She didn't need much coaxing to join. He didn't want a demure plaything. He didn't want the wilting flower. He wanted the

challenge he'd met in the bar. That was their game, and now that they were alone, the stakes were even higher.

They tangled together, a knot of flesh, of arms and legs. Fingers. Tongues. Her bra was lost in the melee. She felt him wince as she dug a heel into his ass. Then he punished her back, scooping her up and hoisting her against him. They broke their kiss as her head lolled. He went for her jugular.

Did she just growl? Or did she say her intended, "Uh, God"? The flat press of a tongue slathered up the side of her neck. Yeah, definitely a growl...

"You're right." His whisper chilled the film of saliva he'd just left. "Feels nice."

Deanna's confusion lasted only a moment. "Ngh!" She flopped back, hips lifting as she felt Noah's hand edge under her panties. His fingertips had a soft touch, dancing down the smooth rise and fall of her mound. "Feels very nice..."

"Gah—"

He cut her cry off with a kiss she could barely keep up with. His fingers sliced around her clit, plying her open. She bowed out, stretching around his fingers, around the pressing hand on her back. She bent and bent until her lips tore off his mouth and her head sank into the backing of the sofa. Then, and only then, did his rifling fingertips find her clit.

Pumped and primed with a night of flirtation and not-so-subtle suggestion, she released everything. The sound she fed through her clenched teeth made her earlier growls sound like a kitten's mew. By the time her orgasm released her, her throat was in tatters and her body burned with exertion. It was one of the greatest orgasms she'd had in a long time.

Noah didn't let her recover. As she pushed the wreckage of her dark hair out of her face, he was there again, flipping her over.

"My turn." With a firm grip on the sides of her thong, he pulled it over her hips. She couldn't see him behind her, but she didn't need to. She felt his weight on the couch. Felt the heat rolling off his skin as he rose up behind her and moved close.

His weight shifted again. He set a hand on her tailbone, sending electricity crawling up her spine. She dug her knees into the plush pillows.

He nudged closer.

“I like the stockings.” His pelvis touched the curve of her buttocks and she shuddered, hanging her head low between her shoulders. He touched her again, a more lurid touch. She couldn’t take much more teasing, and Noah didn’t tease her much. Just a couple strokes along her slick lips. And then—

This time, her moan was more of a cry than something guttural, a punctuating “uh!” that rocketed from somewhere heady and primal. He entered her with one firm thrust and she yielded around him.

The hand at the base of her spine slithered higher, pushed harder. She sank into the sofa, flattening everything but her hips, which she propped up over her knees. By the fifth stroke, he hit the sweet spot and she was most of the way to an orgasm even stronger than the last. The sound of slapping skin and the unfamiliar way that Noah just fucking took her... and she was there.

“There. Therethere!”

He rode her through her climax and into the ramp up of the next. The hand not holding her down grabbed a fist of her ass and squeezed. She ground her teeth. Met his rolling thrusts with ones of her own.

“Spank me.” She heard herself say it. Heard the words emit with a grunt from her own lips. But she certainly hadn’t thought them over. She’d never, in fact, thought anything like them until—

SLAP!

The sodden clap of Noah’s palm across her backside sent a shock wave through her body. That was new. Fun—

SLAP!

“Need to be punished?”

Yes. No. This is ridiculous. And demeaning. And—

The third spank shut the rest of her thinking down for good. It wasn’t hard, but they stung enough to spring fresh rivulets of sweat along her brow and cause her to gnash down on her lower lip. She twisted her head to the side, trying to breathe through her nose and mouth at the same time, her lungs thirsty for oxygen she couldn’t supply.

His thrusts didn’t stop. Didn’t slow. He came at her, seeming to swell thicker and longer with each lunge. He’d crawled inside her head and found that illicit part of her that was aching to get out. As he exploited that

weakness, all she could do was hold onto a small corner of her sanity. When she felt his thumb circle the rim of her asshole, she lost her grip. As she melted into the sofa, a kaleidoscope landscape burst behind her eyes, a boneless pile of sweat-slick flesh.

Ass up, face down, Deanna was vaguely aware of her unladylike posture. Not that she could do a thing about it. Moving seemed like too much effort.

Noah pulled out and crossed the room, where he retrieved a bottle of water from the bar. She watched him twist the cap off and down half its contents. They hadn't bothered turning on more than the light in the entryway, but it was just enough to illuminate his naked masculinity and set fire to the sheen of his sweat. The vision would have gotten her plenty hot and bothered if she'd not maxed out on the hot, and was feeling too good to be bothered.

Deanna sighed, stretching the length of the couch, and propped her head up on her side. She found her voice, hoarse and tender. "They probably charge ten bucks for one of those."

He finished it before he answered. Shadows danced along his throat with each swallow. She took in the rest of his nudity. His muscles seemed chiseled from his slender build, corded tight and rippling. Even after ten years, that sight turned her on.

"Then I suppose you don't want this one?" He held a second bottle out to her, shrugged, and started to lift it to his mouth.

"No, no. I didn't say that. I can just charge it to the case."

"So this is overhead?" He crossed the room, his cock swinging between his thighs, softer, yet still not completely flaccid.

She propped her head on an elbow and regarded Noah. She thought of what they'd just done—the bits and pieces she could summon out of the rolling thunderclouds of her orgasms. "Who are you?"

He took a seat on the couch, his hip brushing against her stomach. "Just a random guy you picked up at a bar?"

Deanna laughed. "That was pretty fun, I have to admit. Unexpected, but fun." She reached out and touched her husband's leg. "Why didn't you come over right away?"

"I had a long flight?"

She rolled her eyes and shoved him.

He tilted his head back and forth before giving the honest answer. "When I walked into that bar and saw you sitting there, I barely recognized you. If we hadn't arranged to meet there after I landed, I'm not sure I would have known it was you."

He was still staring at her a little like that. It reminded her of their earlier days. "So you don't DVR my court appearances and beat off to them at night?"

"Oh, so you have googled yourself recently."

That brought a flame to her face.

"The Noah you married couldn't just walk up to a girl like that. Perfect hair. Perfect outfit. You're literally a celebrity lawyer sitting in an LA bar, surrounded by beautiful people."

"No..." She denied it because she'd be a pretty awful person not to. "That's not really me, you know."

He dismissed her with a shrug, and she caught a glimpse of the cocky guy who'd picked her up. Her stomach fluttered all over again.

"You're kind of right. She's not the side of you I married, but that doesn't mean she's not a little part of you. And believe me, I could grow to like her." He ran his thumb along the lace of her stocking top. "I mean, what's not to like about thigh highs?"

She giggled. "You know, it's kind of weird, but they give me confidence in the court room."

"If your Internet fans only knew..." He focused higher. "And how about that? Is that for confidence?"

Deanna didn't need to look to know what he was talking about. "Well, that's for you." On a whim, she'd had herself waxed bare. She was only in LA once, she'd figured. "But if you want this look to continue, you're going to have to prove that it's worth the pain."

"Didn't I just prove that you like pain?"

Deanna brushed the inside of her thumb along his thigh, against the grain of his soft leg hair. "So what about you, Noah? Was that the secret part of you I saw tonight?"

Noah glanced away, then back just as quick. "I have no idea where that came from..."

"Well, I hope you can find him again. I liked him." They stared at one another, communicating a world in blinks and smiles. They'd learned

something about one another, as well as something in themselves. "You spanked me."

"You asked to be spanked."

"You... that thing... with your thumb." He'd pushed the tip of his thumb into her ass and she wanted to squirm at the thought—equal parts embarrassment and stimulation.

"You seemed to like it."

"It was different." She noticed his erection had begun to reform. She walked her hand up his thigh and cupped his balls. They were heavy, slippery with herself. "You never came."

"No, but you're going to make it right." It wasn't a question.

Deanna circled her hand around the base of his shaft and pumped him. He was looking at her like that again, like she was someone to fuck and make suck, not someone to talk to. She obliged.

She could taste herself as she wrapped her lips around his cock. It wasn't a thing she did often, but as he swelled to fill her mouth, she decided she didn't mind it. Or, at least, the awakened vixen didn't. His breath grew heavy and labored, and she threw herself into the blow job.

Wordlessly, they arranged themselves with Noah lounging back on the sofa, legs splayed, arms thrown over its back, and Deanna servicing him from his right side. She bobbed with enough vigor that a slow trickle of saliva drooled down to the base, where she rubbed it in with her jacking fingers.

"Feel so... good." Noah stumbled over his words as she slurped harder. What she must have looked like!

Keeping in mind the visual, she pushed her hair behind an ear so that he had a clear view and caved her cheeks for a suck so hard his hips jerked up. He hit the back of her throat and she choked off to catch her breath. "Only for you." She showed him how much of a slut she could be, rubbing the swollen head along her cheek as she licked down to the base and swallowed his balls.

"Jesus, babe." She watched him as she worked, a smile tugging at the corners of her lips the whole time. His face tightened into a grimace that went on and on. She'd seen that look dozens of times, yet it was just as exciting as the first. She didn't understand it. Didn't comprehend why she

saw such beauty in that moment, just before his orgasm. But as surely as her heartfelt closing arguments on her best days, it was inspirational.

She managed to cover him with her mouth before he erupted, but only just. She caught one stroke of cum across her cheek, felt it ooze, hot and warm, around her mouth and down her chin as she swallowed the rest. And when his face relaxed and he'd recovered enough to find her again, she was watching.

"Good?" She wiped her face with the palm of her hand.

"Fucking incredible."

She licked his semi-flaccid penis before it could completely settle. "We're not done here, are we? I'm not going to have to go back downstairs and find Craig, am I?"

Noah made a face and she chortled. "Not if you want a home to return to after this trial is over."

Deanna found her feet and offered her his hand. He didn't take it immediately, although he did steal a look or two at her. In just thigh highs and heels, she felt so exposed. "Well, after this particular trial, I'll probably have enough money to buy several places to return to, but none of them would be home."

"Seven hundred dollar shoes, huh?" He stood on his own, so she circled a hand around his cock and led him to the bedroom. He'd already begun to stiffen.

"Eight hundred, dear, and they're not my only pair."

"Did I tell you I wasn't so sure about you taking this case?"

"Yes, you did."

"Something about you being gone for so long, and not having quality time with you?"

"That sounds about right." They stopped before the king-sized bed. The satin throw had been pulled back and folded at the foot and the mountain of pillows had been reformed while she'd been busy litigating. Even in these heels, she had to lift onto her toes to give him a chaste kiss. "I also assured you that I'd make it up to you."

"You don't lose many arguments, do you?"

Deanna shoved him onto his back. Noah caught himself on his elbows after a bounce and she watched his abs flex. "It's how I can afford the shoes. Now, you, into the middle of the bed." He scooted back, she crawled

over him, and by the time she rose to a straddle, he was hard enough that she could sink down.

Deanna threaded her fingers through his short hair, feeling the moisture that had gathered along his scalp. She inhaled his scent—the scent of home. He propped himself up on his hands, bringing their faces close. They kissed, tongues tangling.

Deanna rode him, slow and steady. They'd finally left behind the course of the alpha and the vixen. This was the dessert. The reconnection. He swelled inside her as their heavy breaths created a halo of humid air. He gathered her close, trailing his lips down her neck. She arched as he captured the hardened cap of her breasts in his mouth. His hands squeezed her buttocks. It was a familiar feeling, filled with love, but she wondered if she was imaging the restraint beneath his fingers—maybe the beast wasn't completely exorcised...

Yet still, they stayed on course. They made love with the rise and fall of their hips. She emptied her mind but for the feeling of his hard flesh as it unraveled her sense of self all over again. She loved the way he felt inside her. Loved his cock. In the darkness behind her eyelids, she mused that she could give up everything to feel the stretch of him for the rest of her life.

"Oh, Dee..." He groaned. His mouth had left her breasts—when, she couldn't recall. He'd pulled his knees up behind her and she reclined backwards. He sat up, the heat and thump of his chest following her. She braced herself, one arm behind, the other wrapped around his neck where his muscles danced. His whole body rocked as they fucked, picking up speed. He thrust up into her, flexing his body until his hips left the mattress to meet her. She sought his lips, but neither could focus on a kiss. "Uh, you feel so good..."

"I love you, I love you..." She couldn't think of anything else to say. Anything else to think. She nuzzled her head, nudging his nose. His sniff was sharp, ending in a quick choke. It was the only warning she got.

Noah's moan cascaded over her face. He drove his hips forward one last time and began to empty himself inside her.

She bucked her hips as liquid heat consumed her, turning her blood molten and her world a blinding white. She threw her head back, her mouth open, but the cry caught in her throat. She pumped her pelvis

harder and drove her nails into the back of Noah's neck. His moan stimulated her own, husky and happy to be free.

Noah was there to catch her as she went limp. They flopped backward together, all sweaty and heaving. He stroked her back as the fatigue she'd been carrying around all week started to overwhelm this little reunion. His cock kept twitching, refusing to let the night end, and Deanna wondered how far back her eyes could roll before they were permanently damaged.

"Should I apologize for this?" His voice was rough around the edges in a way that she really, really liked. She had no clue what he was talking about though, and was too tired to open her eyes.

"Don't apologize for anything you did tonight." She snuggled close as the sweat began to cool and pulled the Egyptian cotton flat sheet over them. His hand, she realized, was stroking her rear, which was still a little raw. "Would the guy who spanked me ever say he's sorry?"

"So you liked him?"

She looked up through a curtain of hair. He regarded her without judgment. This wasn't a test. There was no wrong answer except the false one. She didn't want to give that. "He was fun. I hope we can play again. Sometime soon."

"Hmm..." He brushed her hair away and kissed her forehead. He looked as exhausted as she felt, yet she felt him begin to stir where he was still penetrating her. "You're off until Sunday afternoon, right? Is tomorrow morning soon enough?"

About the Author

Kenny Wright is just a guy who writes what he likes to read: steamy, explicit erotica that's just crazy enough to be true. Husband to his beautiful

wife, father to his rambunctious daughter, and food slave to his needy cat, he squeezes writing in when he probably should be sleeping. Kenny believes in a world where men read and appreciate erotica, and hopes to contribute to it word by word.

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